HOW TO MAKE THE WORLD LESS UNFAIR

FAIRNESS has been one of my guiding principles in life. The simplest definition I can give to this particular value is:

FAIRNESS is our obligation to make impartial and objective decisions.

After a series of research and contemplation on this value, I have come up with these three conducts that I would like to share:

1. Our conduct must be free from competing self-interest – in other words, we refrain from engaging in the decision-making process unless we have made full disclosure to the affected stakeholders and have obtained their consent to proceed.

   This conduct is manifested by demonstrating transparency in all-decision-making processes.

2. Our conduct must also be free from discrimination – in other words, we do not discriminate others based on but not limited to gender, race, age, wealth, religion, disability, nationality or sexual orientation.

   This conduct is manifested by providing equal access to information for those who are authorized to have that particular information.

3. Our conduct must also be free from favoritism – in other words, we apply the rules of the Employer. We do not hire/fire, reward/punish, or award/deny contracts based on personal considerations.

   This conduct is manifested by making opportunities equally available to qualified parties.

These three conducts to FAIRNESS I believe, could assist us in making wise decisions especially when faced with difficult situation where we may be asked to compromise our honor.

I would like to bring you to the moral aspect of FAIRNESS.

When I was writing this, I wondered how FAIRNESS is presented in the bible. And to my realization, FAIRNESS is also God's expectation in business transactions. For instance, Proverbs 16:11 says "The Lord wants weights and measures to be honest and every sale to be fair".

Thanks by the way to my officemate Mr. Galahad Adamos for the verse and reflection. Now, it is clear to me that FAIRNESS is a moral requisite for us to live in God's kingdom.
I would like to bring you, this time, to the professional aspect of FAIRNESS.

Now that we are preparing ourselves for *global integration* (e.g. the ASEAN Economic Community, the European Union) I'd like to share something that is of global interest: I am a member of Project Management Institute, this is a global community of project management professionals and practitioners. Allow me to talk about its code of ethics and professional conduct. PMI, like other international professional organizations, developed its Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct through a variety of mechanisms which include focus group discussions and internet surveys among members and practitioners globally, as well as conducting researches regarding best practices in the development of ethical standards. And as a result, the PMI aspire four mandatory values which it believes should be embraced by the global community. And you know what? FAIRNESS is one of them (other three: respect, responsibility, honesty). Isn't it delightful to know, that while we are trying to integrate our selves to the global economy, we bring with us the same FAIRNESS the global community aspires?

It is my hope that we continuously use FAIRNESS to build upon and evolve our personal and professional attitude. By doing so, we will make the world less unfair.